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Foreword to AniNex workshop 2022

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Editorial

Foreword to AniNex workshop 2022

Editors' Foreword:

We are pleased to present this special section of the journal Computers & Graphics, featuring selected papers from the 4th AniNex workshop on Next Generation Computer Animation Techniques, held in conjunction with the 35th International Conference on Computer Animation and Social Agents (CASA 2022) in Nanjing, China, during 5–7 July, 2022.

The AniNex workshop provides a platform for researchers and practitioners in the field of computer graphics to share their latest findings and discuss future research directions. The workshop focuses on cutting-edge research related to all perspectives on computer animation, including interdisciplinary approaches and applications. In this edition, the workshop puts a special emphasis on advanced physics-based animation techniques and machine learning solutions for computer generated imagery.

This section features a selection of three high-quality papers that were presented at the AniNex workshop. These papers cover a wide range of topics related to computer animation, including particle driven fluid simulation, machine learning driven motion recognition, and a novel training platform prototype for patients' rehabilitation. Namely:

- Yanrui Xu, Yuanmu Xu, Yuege Xiong, Yin Dou, Xiaojuan Ban, Xiaokun Wang, Jian Chang, Jian Jun Zhang, Anisotropic Screen Space Rendering for Particle-Based Fluid Simulation
- Ruijie Hou, Zhihao Wang, Ruimin Ren, Cao Yang, Zhao Wang, Multi-Channel Network: Constructing Efficient GCN Baselines for Skeleton-based Action Recognition
- Hui Liang, Shiqing Liu, Yi Wang, Junjun Pan, Yazhou Zhang, Xiaohang Dong, Multi-user Upper Limb Rehabilitation Training System Integrating Social Interaction

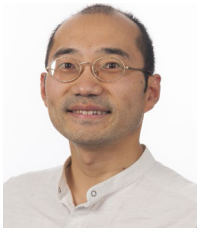
We hope that the papers in this special journal section will inspire further research and development in computer animation and related fields.

We would like to express our gratitude to all the authors who submitted their works to the AniNex workshop, the program committee members who provided their valuable reviews, and the CASA 2023 conference organizers who ensured a successful event. We would also like to extend our special thanks to Professor Daniel Thalmann and Professor Nadia Magnenat Thalmann for their continuous support for the AniNex workshops, as well as Computers & Graphics editor, Professor Joaquim Jorge, journal manager, Ms. Abigail Campbell, and content acquisition specialist, Mr. David Ren, for their kind support through the process.

We acknowledge that this workshop has received support by the EU H2020 Marie Skłodowska-Curie Scheme (Multifluid, 895941 and CfACTs, 900025).

Declaration of competing interest

The authors declare that they have no known competing financial interests or personal relationships that could have appeared to influence the work reported in this paper.



Jian Chang is a professor in the National Centre for Computer Animation at Bournemouth University, UK and director of Centre for Applied Creative Technologies, a Marie Skłodowska-Curie Cofund Postdoctoral Training Centre. His research interests include physics based modeling (deformation & fluid), motion synthesis, virtual reality (surgery simulation), and novel HCI (eye tracking, gesture control and haptic).



Xiaokun Wang is an associate professor in Intelligence Science and Technology, University of Science and Technology Beijing, China. He is currently working at the National Centre for Computer Animation at Bournemouth University funded by the EU's Horizon 2020 Marie Curie Individual Fellowship. His research interests include computer graphics, virtual reality and human–computer interaction.



Alexandru Telea is full professor of visual data mining at the Information and Computing Science Department, Utrecht University, where he leads the Visualization and Graphics research group. His research interests are at the crossroads of scientific visualization, information visualization, and shape and image processing. Specific application fields he is interested in are visual analytics for explainable AI, shape-and-image segmentation and simplification using medial structures, and visual exploration of large networks and trail-sets from air traffic control.

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Jiří Kosinka is an associate professor at the University of Groningen in the Netherlands, where he leads the Scientific Visualization and Computer Graphics research group. His research focus lies in the area of Visual Computing, with special emphasis on Geometric Modeling and Vector Graphics.



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Jian Jun Zhang is currently a Professor of Computer Graphics at the National Centre for Computer Animation, Bournemouth University, UK, and leads the Computer Animation Research Centre. His research focuses on a number of topics relating to 3D computer animation, including virtual human modeling and simulation, geometric modeling, motion synthesis, deformation and physics-based animation. He is also interested in virtual reality and medical visualization and simulation.

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